



Home made lighting kit

A reddit user used an automated machining tool to create a custom lighting kit for his RAM modules. <https://dgit.in/jun20-112>



Some like it hot

Malware on this person's computer stressed the machine so much that it burned his hand! <https://dgit.in/jun20-113>

AGENT001

drives are primarily CMR. Using SMR in NAS drives defeats the purpose of using new-age technologies such as ZFS. When used in a desktop PC normally, these SMR drives will rarely face a buffer overflow except in certain situations where you are downloading large games or moving all of your movies in one go.

Thankfully, all three manufacturers have published lists of which hard drives use SMR and which are CMR, so that you can make an educated purchase. Except WD, none of the other manufacturers used SMR technology in NAS drives so the impact of this silent switcheroo is limited to consumers of just one brand. Last we heard, there's

a class-action lawsuit brewing for WD for this very reason. So folks, if you're looking to buy a new hard drive, head over to the manufacturer's website and check if you're getting an SMR or CMR drive. For drives that will see a lot of continuous transfers of large files, stick to CMR. For everything else, it doesn't matter which one you go with. 

BUYING ADVICE

NEW RYZEN 3 BUILD

Q Hi!

I have been researching a lot to buy a gaming PC under ₹25,000 price range. I was about to buy AMD Ryzen 3 with the inbuilt vega graphics and no GPU and then the pandemic hit. I want to use it mainly for rendering (I am an architect who uses sketchup for 3D modelling and Vray for rendering. Sometimes lumion.) and some gaming too.

But now AMD announced Ryzen 3 3100 and 3300X. I know they don't have inbuilt graphics. But they seem more powerful. What would you



AMD Ryzen 3 3300X

suggest? Should I still go for the AMD Ryzen 3 with inbuilt graphics, which will be the cheaper option or should I get a 3300X (when it releases in India) with an entry level graphics card? (if yes, can u suggest a graphics card?)

Thank you!

—Ferdinant Lopez



Hey Ferdinant,

Let's take a look at the graphics capability of the AMD APUs and examine their equivalents. If you were to get the AMD Ryzen 3200G or 3400G,

then you will get Radeon Vega 8 or Vega 11 graphics with the APUs. The 3200G costs ₹7,959 and the 3400G costs ₹13,401. Vega 11's scores in a generic graphics benchmark are slightly bested by the Radeon RX 550 and the NVIDIA GT 1030. Both of these are priced around ₹6.5K and the GT 1030 is better than the RX 550. So that's the bare minimum you'll have to spend to get an equivalent graphics card when you switch to the new Ryzen 3 3100 and 3300X.

The Ryzen 3 3100 costs ₹6,866 whereas the Ryzen 3 3300X costs ₹11,310. Since you haven't shared much details about the rest of the configuration, we're going to proceed with certain assumptions about your PC. Mostly that you're spending purely on the CPU/Mobo/GPU/RAM while retaining everything else. Let's now see what each configuration works out to be:

CPU	3200G	3400G	3100	3300X
GPU	NA	NA	GT1030	GT1030
Total	7959	13401	13366	17810
CPU Perf	100%	147%	167%	182%
GPU Perf	100%	121%	149%	149%

If you were planning a Ryzen 3400G build then shifting to a Ryzen 3 3100 + GT 1030 build is a no brainer. You're getting a better CPU and GPU, however, if you can stretch your budget by 4.5K, then the Ryzen 3 3300X + GT 1030 combination is much better from a CPU perspective. Moreover, Sketchup with V-Ray has support for CUDA under the Hybrid rendering option so you can use your GPU to accelerate your rendering workloads. This means whatever more you can spend on an NVIDIA GPU will help with your workloads.

EXTERNAL DVD DRIVE

Q Hi Agent001

Hope you and Team Digit are doing well during this pandemic.

The optical drive in my HP Notebook 15-ac092tu is not working. I also tried the recommended Sequential & Random Read tests mentioned in the HP Support website. The tests failed and I took the issue to the HP support forum with the Failure ID. I did try with various discs but didn't try removing and reinstalling or cleaning the lenses as I don't have any idea on that. I didn't use it for a very long time and that might be the root cause of this I guess.

Anyway now I couldn't experience the Digit DVDs in my laptop and now I've decided to buy an External USB Optical Drive. Could you please suggest a good quality one?

—Aravind Ram



ASUS SDRW-08D2S-U LITE



Hey Aravind,

We also have an e-DVD option that's available online. I'm assuming you have bandwidth issues or a strict firewall blocking access leading to this purchase decision. You can always check out the ASUS SDRW-08D2S-U LITE which comes under ₹2K and is an 8x external DVD-RW drive. 